BWI Instagram & Ad Performance report (*2022 - 2025*)

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Analysis of 636 Instagram posts (May 2022-Feb 2025) and 13 Meta ad campaigns (Feb-Aug 2026) finds that Documentation-style content converts best per viewer, organic engagement has stayed flat for three years, and paid cost-per-lead rose roughly 25x between February and June 2026 before partially recovering in August.

1. Business context

Business Wisdom Institute (BWI) runs organic Instagram content to build an audience, and paid Meta ad campaigns to convert that audience into seminar leads. Lithe Agency's own paid-ads reports (Feb–Aug 2026) found that image creative won for cold-audience prospecting while video won for retargeting, but that conclusion rested on a handful of campaigns.

This analysis asks two questions: which organic content actually earns engagement once audience size is accounted for, and does three years of organic history support or complicate what the paid-ads reports concluded.

2. Data & limitations

Source	Period	Volume	Captures
BWI Instagram content log	May 2022 - Feb 2025	636 posts	Reach, engagement, content type, format, per post
BWI Meta ad campaigns	Feb - Aug 2026	13 campaigns	Spend, reach, results, leads, per campaign

Several limitations shape how these findings should be read:

- No data exists for either source between March 2025 and January 2026.
- Facebook tracking is inconsistent through 2022-2024 and stops entirely by 2025; Instagram is used as the sole reliable organic channel.
- Reach figures include a mix of organic and paid-boosted posts. 25 posts, almost all tagged Promotional, It show reach more than 20x the median alongside disproportionately low engagement, the signature of paid boosting mixed into an organic tracker. This was not separated out and should be weighed when interpreting reach-based findings.
- One post ("3 quotes from Seneca," *Aug 2022*) recorded more likes than reach, an internal data-entry error; its engagement rate was excluded from analysis.
- The 13 paid campaigns span 3 objectives (*9 Leads, 3 Sales, 1 Awareness*) and are 92% video creative, so a paid video-vs-image comparison is not possible from this data.

3. Methodology

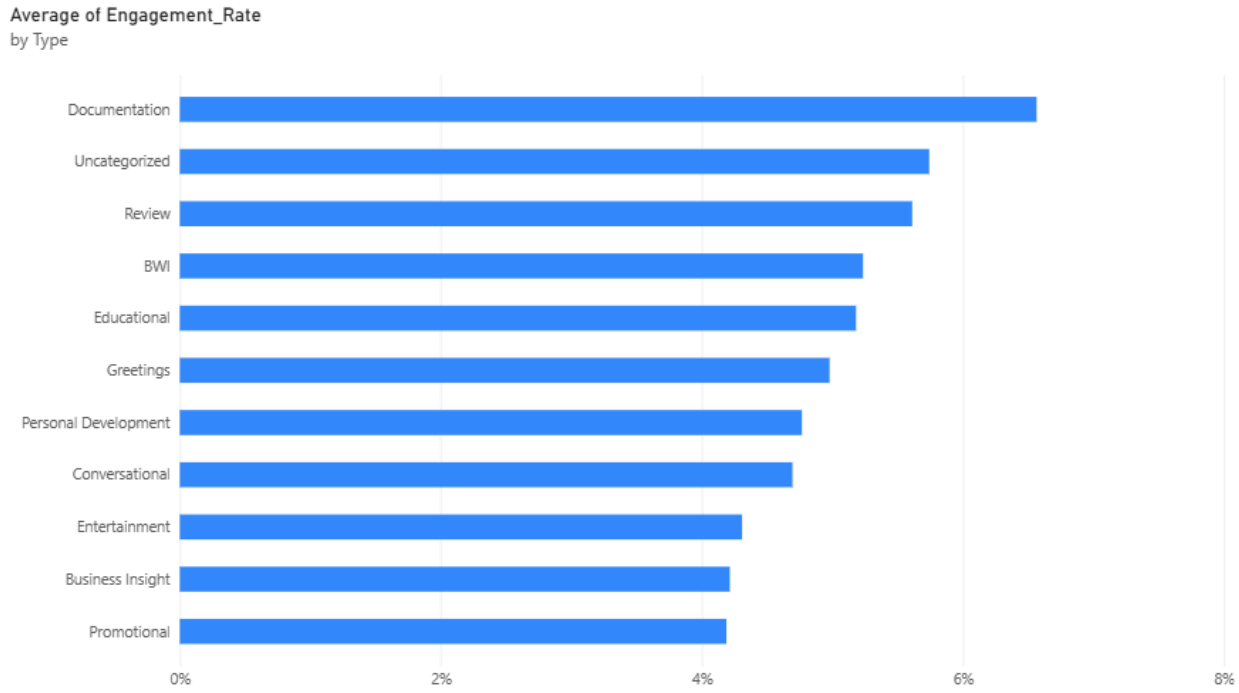
Engagement Rate (engagement ÷ reach) is used throughout instead of raw engagement counts, since raw counts favor whichever posts happened to reach the largest audience rather than which posts actually resonated with the people who saw them.

Content Type was consolidated from roughly 30 raw spellings, abbreviations and multi-tagged values (typos, Indonesian synonyms, combined tags like "BI/Promotional") into 11 clean categories, confirmed against sample size before being used in any comparison.

Format (Video/Image) was inferred from the log's Slides field: entries reading "Video" were logged as Format = Video; numeric slide counts were logged as Format = Image.

All cleaning, analysis and modelling was done in Python (pandas, matplotlib, statsmodels).

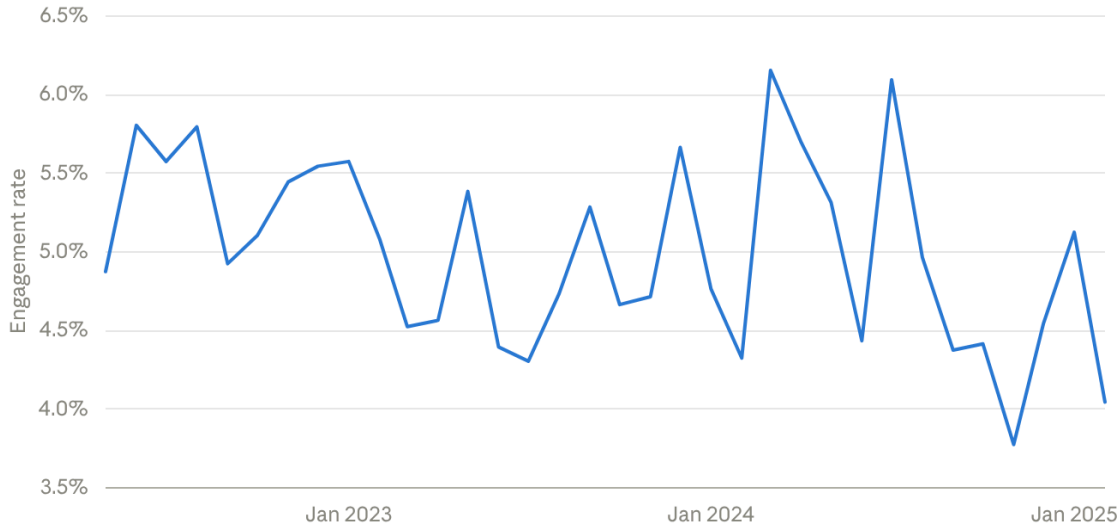
Content type and format performance



Visualised by PowerBI · 636 posts, May 2022-Feb 2025

Documentation-style content (event coverage, behind-the-scenes) earns the highest engagement rate at 6.56%, despite modest reach, well above Promotional (4.19%) and Business Insight (4.21%), the two most frequently posted categories. Format (Video vs. Image) shows far less spread than Type, consistent with the regression finding that format is not statistically significant once content type is controlled for.

Engagement rate trend, May 2022–Feb 2025

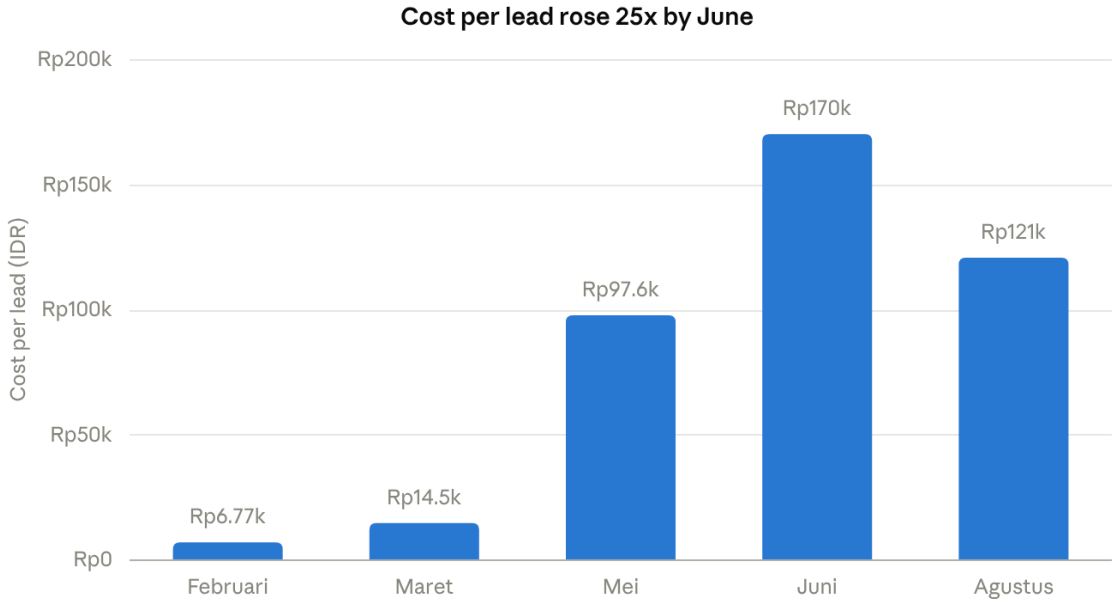


Python (pandas) · monthly average, 636 posts

Monthly engagement rate has moved in a stable band between roughly 3.8% and 6.2% across the full 33-month window, with no sustained upward or downward trend. The lowest point (3.77%, Nov 2024) and highest (6.15%, Mar 2024) sit within a similar range to values seen back in mid-2022, suggesting overall organic performance has plateaued rather than grown or declined.

Bridge: organic vs paid advertising

BWI's paid campaigns are almost entirely video (12 of 13), unlike the organic data, a video-vs-image cost comparison isn't possible here, since BWI hasn't tested image creative in paid Leads campaigns the way it naturally varies organically.



BWI Meta ad campaigns · Leads objective · Feb - Aug 2026

Across the 9 Leads-objective campaigns, cost per lead rose from Rp6,770 in February to a peak of Rp169,981 in June (25x Increase) before easing to Rp120,649 in August. This lines up with issues Lithe Agency's own reports flagged: campaigns repeatedly restarting Meta's "learning phase", and tracking discrepancies between Meta and BWI's GASS system.

Predictive model

A regression of Engagement Rate on content Type, Format and Day of week (522 posts) explains about 14% of the variation ($R^2 = 0.143$), modest, meaning most of what drives engagement is specific to each post rather than its category, format or posting day. Five factors were statistically significant ($p < 0.05$), each measured against a baseline post (BWI-tagged, Image, posted Friday):

Factor	Effect (percentage points)	p-value
Documentation	+1.20	0.017
Saturday	+0.88	0.044
Thursday	+0.83	0.043
Promotional	−1.19	0.011
Business Insight	−1.34	0.012

Format (Video vs. Image) was not statistically significant ($p = 0.132$) once Type and Day were controlled for, reinforcing the earlier finding that format matters far less than content type.

Recommendations

- **Produce more Documentation-style content** (*event coverage, behind-the-scenes*). It converts attention into engagement most efficiently of any category, despite lower reach, a data-backed case for more of it, not less.
- **Separate organic from paid-boosted reach at the source.** Current tracking mixes the two, concentrated in Promotional posts, which distorts any reach-based comparison until it's fixed.
- **Investigate the Feb -> Jun 2026 cost-per-lead spike** before scaling ad spend further, in particular the repeated "learning phase" resets and Meta/GASS tracking mismatches Lithe Agency's own reports already flagged.
- **Test image creative in paid Leads campaigns.** Paid is currently 92% video with no organic-style variation to compare against, so there's no evidence yet on whether video is actually the right choice there.
- **Shift some posting toward Saturday and Thursday.** Both show a modest, statistically real engagement bump, a low-cost scheduling change.
- **Incorporate consumer retention features/edits such as**: Sound effects, Double Camera, etc.
- **Use Payment Gateway,** Incorporate third-party payment gateway for purchases to be counted in GASS.

Limitations & future work

- The regression explains only 14% of engagement variance; caption text, imagery and external events likely matter more than category, format or day, and none of those were modelled here.
- Some categories have small samples (Conversational n=13, Uncategorized n=11), so their estimates carry more uncertainty than Documentation or Promotional, which have over 90 posts each.
- The March 2025 - January 2026 data gap prevents a continuous view connecting the organic history to the 2026 ad campaigns.
- Future work: pull ad reach directly from Meta Ads Manager rather than a shared spreadsheet, to separate organic from paid-boosted reach at the source; extend the predictive model with caption-level text features if that data becomes available.